

Data Sharing Champion: Tackling Early-Onset Cancers in Young Adults

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News from NCI's Office of Data Sharing

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Tackling Early-Onset Cancers in Young Adults

The National Cancer Institute (NCI) defines early-onset cancers (EOC) as cancers that are typically prevalent in individuals aged 50 and older but are now being diagnosed with increasing incidence among adults aged 18–49. Tackling the nearly 80% rise in these cancers in young adults since the 1990s is a priority for NCI to protect current and future generations.

NCI and the broader cancer research community have grown increasingly concerned about this trend. While NCI is already conducting and supporting important research in this area, there is a clear need to approach this complex scientific challenge in a more coordinated and holistic way. To that end, NCI is working to build partnerships, foster collaboration, and raise awareness. These efforts will help set priorities, accelerate progress, and bring sharper focus to this important area of cancer research. The goals of the NCI EOC effort are to better understand causal factors, molecular pathology, and the unique needs associated with survivorship.

As part of this NCI-wide effort, NCI issued Early-Onset Cancer (EOC) Administrative Supplements to support the development of research tools, resources, and pilot studies that advance the understanding of early-onset cancers. Dr. LeaAnn Bailey is leading and coordinating this effort at NCI. The funded projects cover diverse areas such as environmental contributors, metabolic and microbial influences, reproductive factors, drug repurposing, and disease-specific initiation pathways. These projects include research on breast, colorectal, uterine, kidney, and pancreatic cancers affecting this age group. They will contribute a wide range of de-identified data: clinical data (e.g., demographic and phenotypic information); genomic data (e.g., ultrahigh-depth sequencing, bulk and single-cell RNA-seq, and ATAC-seq); imaging data (whole-slide and stereoscope imaging, immunohistochemistry, multiplex immunofluorescence, and flow cytometry); as well as epigenomic and proteomic data. In addition, functional assay data (e.g., proliferation assays, tumor volume measurements, and serum ELISA results) and analysis workflows will be shared to support integrative and secondary analyses.

Data from these projects will be deposited in established repositories (e.g., [dbGaP/SRA](#), [GEO](#), [HTAN Data Portal](#)), with controlled-access data managed in accordance with NIH policies. Analysis code and workflows will be made openly available via GitHub, and patient-derived organoid lines will be shared through standard material transfer agreements. These efforts promote broad and responsible data access. Dr. Bailey is closely working with NCI's Office of Data Sharing to provide investigators data sharing guidance throughout the grant period.

Studying these increasingly common cancers in young adults provides an unique opportunity to deepen our understanding of translational science and the unique needs that patients, caregivers, and providers require to provide optimal care. In summary, we hope that these efforts will alter the trajectory of young lives for the better. For additional information, please contact LeeAnn Bailey at leeann.bailey@nih.gov.

Event

NIAID Data Science Webinar Series: *Introduction to APIs*

Please join the next NIAID Data Science Webinar on Application Programming Interfaces (APIs) and how they can connect biomedical data systems by enabling (meta)data sharing.

[Registration.](#)

Presenters: Doug Fils & Christine Kirkpatrick (GO FAIR US) | Lisa Mayer & Dasha Pokutnaya (ODSET/NIAID)

Date & Time: Tuesday, March 31st at 12 PM ET/9 AM PT

Introduction to Application Programming Interface (APIs) will provide a high level introduction to web API architecture focusing on guidance from the NIAID Blueprint. The presentation will introduce the role of URL patterns, versioning approaches and more to the development of long term access to research metadata and data. API management and technical specifications will be presented, enabling you to create discoverable, self-documenting machine interfaces. Finally, the webinar will explore the integration of APIs within the AI landscape.

We'd love to hear from you! Contact the ODS team at: nciofficeofdatasharing@mail.nih.gov

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